

EXPERIMENT 3

Application Building Using Zia Assistant

1. Aim

To explore how Zia Assistant can be used in Zoho Creator to develop an application from a natural-language requirement and reduce the amount of manual configuration involved in application development.

2. Introduction

Zia Assistant is Zoho's AI-powered assistant that helps users work with applications through natural-language instructions. In Zoho Creator, it can assist in converting a described business requirement into application elements such as forms, fields, reports, and dashboards. These generated elements can subsequently be checked, edited, tested, and adapted according to the application's requirements.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To learn how AI assistance can be integrated with low-code application development.
- To create a practical application by describing its requirements in natural language.
- To understand the different components generated during application creation.
- To reduce repetitive setup work through AI-assisted development.
- To verify and customise the generated application before final use.

4. Application Selected: Food Delivery System

For this experiment, a **Food Delivery System** is considered as the application. It contains modules for handling orders, individual order items, customer information, menu items, and restaurant branches. A dashboard is also provided to present important order, payment, and activity information in a summarized form.

5. Procedure

1. Log in to Zoho Creator and access the application-building interface.
2. Start the creation of a new application using Zia Assistant.
3. Provide a natural-language description of the required Food Delivery System.
4. Allow Zia to interpret the requirement and generate the initial application structure.
5. Examine the forms, fields, and other components suggested by the assistant.
6. Check the generated records, reports, and application views.
7. Preview the application and verify whether the generated components meet the requirements.
8. Modify or refine the components wherever necessary and save the application.

6. Application Components

The Food Delivery System consists of the following major components:

- **Dashboard:** Presents summarized information through counters, payment statistics, quick-access options, and charts.
- **Order Records:** Maintains information related to customer orders.
- **Order Line Items:** Contains the individual food items associated with each order.

- **Customer Profiles:** Maintains customer details such as name, email, phone number, address, customer code, registration date, and loyalty category.
- **Menu Items:** Used to maintain the available food items.
- **Restaurant Branches:** Stores information related to the different restaurant locations.

7. Advantages

- Allows users to describe application requirements in a more natural manner.
- Speeds up the initial creation of application components.
- Minimizes repetitive manual configuration.
- Makes rapid prototyping of business applications easier.
- Allows the generated application to be reviewed and further customised.

8. Limitations

- The generated application needs to be checked before it is used.
- Some requirements may require manual modification after AI generation.
- The available assistance depends on the features supported by Zia and Zoho Creator.
- More advanced application logic may still require manual configuration or Deluge scripting.

9. Screenshots

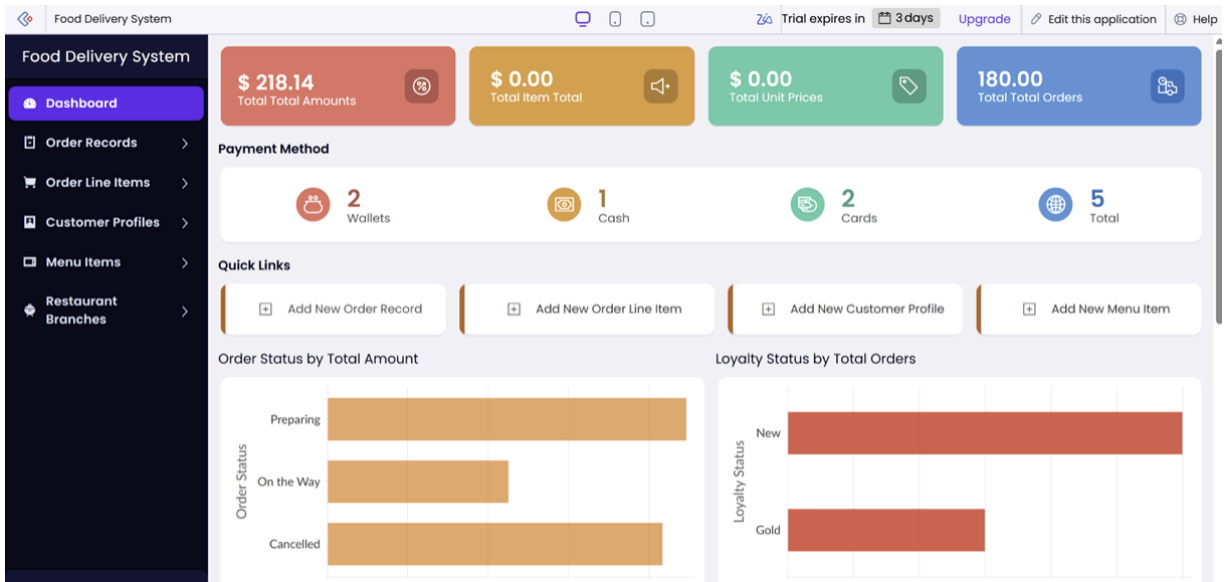


Figure 1: Food Delivery System dashboard generated and configured in Zoho Creator.

Line Item Code	Unit Price	Item Total	Special Requests	Order	Menu Item
ORD-1001				ORD-1001	Spicy Tuna Roll
ORD-1003				ORD-1003	Grilled Chicken Burger
ORD-1004				ORD-1004	Vegetable Stir Fry
					Chocolate Lava Cake
					Fresh Fruit Salad
ORD-1002				ORD-1002	Spicy Tuna Roll
ORD-1003				ORD-1003	Grilled Chicken Burger
					Vegetable Stir Fry
					Chocolate Lava Cake
ORD-1002				ORD-1002	Spicy Tuna Roll
ORD-1003				ORD-1003	Grilled Chicken Burger
ORD-1004				ORD-1004	Vegetable Stir Fry
ORD-1005				ORD-1005	Chocolate Lava Cake
					Fresh Fruit Salad

Figure 2: Order Line Items view showing the generated application data structure.

Customer Name	Email Address	Phone Number	Delivery Address	Customer Code	Registration Date	Loyalty Status
Eva Brown	eva.b@example.com	+18269769179	654 Cedar Ln	CUST005	28-Sep-2024	New
David Lee	d.lee@example.com	+17347186925	321 Elm Dr	CUST004	12-Sep-2024	New
Carol Martinez	carol.m@example.com	+19569368387	789 Pine St	CUST003	05-Oct-2024	New
Bob Williams	bob.w@example.com	+17172092759	456 Oak Blvd	CUST002	20-Aug-2024	Gold
Alice Johnson	alice.j@example.com	+19132478859	123 Maple Ave	CUST001	15-Sep-2024	Gold

Figure 3: Customer Profiles view displaying generated fields and sample records.

10. Result

The application was successfully developed with the support of Zia Assistant in Zoho Creator. The Food Delivery System demonstrated how an application requirement given in natural language can be converted into useful components such as forms, records, reports, and dashboards, while reducing the amount of manual setup required.